MENTAL HEALTH AWARENESS AMONG THE COLLEGE STUDENTS

CHAPTER 1

INTRODUCTION

Mental health awareness among college students has become an increasingly important topic in recent years. As young adults transition from high school to college, they often face new challenges that can impact their emotional and psychological well-being. These challenges include academic pressures, social adjustments, financial concerns, and the struggle to establish independence.

Despite its significance, mental health is still largely stigmatized or misunderstood in many college environments, leading many students to suffer in silence. College life is a pivotal time when habits and coping mechanisms are formed, making awareness and support for mental health crucial. Unfortunately, the combination of stressors like demanding coursework, peer pressure, and sometimes loneliness can contribute to issues such as anxiety, depression, and burnout.

Without proper awareness and resources, students might not recognize their own struggles or know where to seek help. This lack of awareness not only affects academic performance but also personal growth and long-term well-being. Furthermore, the diverse backgrounds and experiences of students mean that mental health challenges do not look the same for everyone.

Some may face cultural barriers, while others might feel isolated due to identity or socioeconomic status. Therefore, mental health awareness on college campuses needs to address these variances compassionately and inclusively. In recent years, many institutions have taken steps to improve mental health services, introducing counselling centres, peer support groups, and educational workshops.

However, the effectiveness of these measures depends heavily on ongoing awareness campaigns that normalize conversations about mental health. When students feel safe and understood, they are more likely to seek help early, reducing the risk of severe consequences.

Raising mental health awareness among college students is not just about providing resources but also about fostering a culture of empathy and understanding.

It involves educating students about recognizing symptoms, supporting peers, and challenging the stigma around mental illness. Creating such an environment can empower students to manage their mental health proactively and thrive both academically and personally. Given the mounting pressures today's college students face-from academic expectations to

global uncertainties mental health awareness has never been more vital. By acknowledging and addressing these issues openly, colleges can help ensure that students are not only academically successful but also mentally resilient and well-supported.

This introduction sets the stage for exploring practical approaches and strategies to improve mental health awareness among college students, ultimately fostering healthier campus communities. While the efforts by institutions to provide support are commendable, a critical first step toward effective intervention is a clear, data-driven understanding of the current landscape.

Existing data often provides a general overview, but it frequently lacks the specificity needed to tailor interventions to a particular student body. Therefore, this project endeavours to move beyond anecdotal evidence by conducting a targeted Survey on Mental Health Awareness Among College Students.

This research is crucial because it allows us to quantify the extent of awareness, identify specific knowledge gaps (e.g., about available campus resources, symptom recognition, and peer support skills), and pinpoint the prevailing sources of stigma within the community. The insights gathered will serve as a diagnostic tool, providing actionable intelligence to campus administrators, counselling services, and student organizations.

By transforming subjective concerns into objective metrics, this survey aims to provide the necessary foundation for developing more precise, impactful, and student-centric mental health awareness campaigns and support systems.

CHAPTER 2

OBJECTIVES OF THE STUDY

PRIMARY OBJECTIVES:

To Assess the mental health awareness, challenges, support system among college students, and to understand how these factors impact their overall well-being and academic performance.

SECONDARY OBJECTIVES:

1. To Analyse the Awareness of Mental health among the college students.
2. To know the knowledge of Mental health among the college students.
3. To Identify the major stress factors affecting college students.
4. To explore whether stigma influences students decision to seek help.

CHAPTER 3

REVIEW FOR CONTEXT

ARTICLE 1:

D., Downs, M. F., Golberstein, E., & Zivin, K. (2009). Stigma and help seeking for mental health among college students. Medical Care Research and Review, 66(5), 522–541.

OBJECTIVE:

The prevalence of school shootings and other campus violence incidents have called attention to the increasing number of college students who are living with Mental Health Disorders (MHDs).

There is a substantial amount of literature on MHDs among college students who are attending 4-year universities. However, the literature is lacking research on MHDs among community college students.

The purpose of the current study was to analyse archival data to investigate residential community college students' awareness of MHDs and their willingness to refer a friend who was showing signs of an MHD to facilitative and debilitative resources.

The results of a multivariate analysis of covariance (MANCOVA) revealed that residential community college students who had high levels of awareness of MHDs were significantly more willing to refer a friend who was showing signs of an MHD to facilitative resources (for example taking them to the counselling centre) compared to students with low levels of awareness. This finding was significant at the $p = .000$ level with a strong effect size, $= .13$.

In addition, male students were significantly more likely than female students to refer a friend who was showing signs of MHDs to debilitative resources (encouraging them to engage in risky behaviours).

Implications for how community college counsellors and administrators can take initiatives to increase students' awareness of MHDs. Kalkbrenner, M. T., & Hernández, T. J. (2017). Community college students' awareness of risk factors for mental health problems and referrals to facilitative and debilitative resources.

ARTICLE 2:

Eisenberg, D., Downs, M. F., Golberstein, E., & Zivin, K. (2009). Stigma and help seeking for mental health among college students. Medical Care Research and Review.

OBJECTIVE:

Mental illness stigma has been identified by national policy makers as an important barrier to help seeking for mental health. Using a random sample of 5,555 students from a diverse set of 13 universities, we conducted one of the first empirical studies of the association of help-seeking behaviour with both perceived public stigma and people's own stigmatizing attitudes (personal stigma).

There were three main findings:

(a) Perceived public stigma was considerably higher than personal stigma;

(b) personal stigma was higher among students with any of the following characteristics: male, younger, Asian, international, more religious, or from a poor family;

(c) personal stigma was significantly and negatively associated with measures of help seeking (perceived need and use of psychotropic medication, therapy, and nonclinical sources of support)

whereas perceived stigma was not significantly associated with help seeking. These findings can help inform efforts to reduce the role of stigma as a barrier to help seeking.

ARTICLE 3:

Sontag-Padilla, L., Dunbar, M. S., Ye, F., Kase, C., Fein, R., Abelson, S., Seelam, R., & Stein, B. D. (2018).

OBJECTIVE:

To examine the relationship between college students' familiarity with and involvement in Active Minds, a student peer organization focused on increasing mental health awareness, decreasing stigma, and affecting mental health knowledge, attitudes, and behaviours.

Methods:

Students (N = 1,129) across 12 California colleges completed three waves of a web-based survey during the 2016–2017 academic year to assess familiarity with and involvement in Active Minds and mental health attitudes, behaviours, and perceived knowledge. Fixed-effects models assessed relations between changes in organization familiarity and involvement and changes in mental health-related outcomes over time overall and stratified by students' baseline engagement (i.e., familiarity/involvement) with Active Minds.

Result:

Overall, increased familiarity with Active Minds was associated with increases in perceived knowledge (0.40; $p < .001$) and decreases in stigma over time (−0.33; $p < .001$). Increased involvement was associated with increases in perceived knowledge (0.40; $p < .001$) and a range of helping behaviours.

Associations differed by students' baseline engagement with Active Minds. For students with low engagement, increased familiarity with Active Minds was associated with decreased stigma and improved perceived knowledge. For students with moderate baseline engagement, increasing involvement with Active Minds was associated with increases in helping behaviours (e.g., providing emotional support, connecting others to services) over time.

Conclusion:

Student peer organizations' activities can improve college student mental health attitudes and perceived knowledge and significantly increase helping behaviours. Such organizations can complement more traditional programs and play an important role in improving the campus climate with respect to mental health.

ARTICLE 4:

Shim, Y. R. (2022). Mental health education, awareness, stigma. Journal of Mental Health & Clinical Psychology.

OBJECTIVE:

The present study examined whether psychoeducational tools are beneficial in improving awareness and reducing stigma regarding mental health. This study aims to increase mental health awareness and reduce the stigma associated with mental illness.

Methods:

The study is quantitative research. In this study, 147 students registered in the Abnormal Psychology course, which focuses on mental illness, were recruited. Students signed informed consent and participated in the study voluntarily. Students completed the demographic questions, Beliefs Toward Mental Illness Scale (BTMI), and questionnaire.

Result:

Our findings revealed a significant difference in beliefs and awareness about mental health and a decrease in stigma after students completed the Abnormal Psychology course.

The statistical analysis revealed that students believe mental health is more curable and less embarrassing after taking mental health education. Finally, our findings demonstrated a direct impact of the educational experience on student attitudes toward mental health.

CHAPTER 4

OBSERVATION

The study conducted by Kalkbrenner and Hernández (2017) provides valuable insight into the level of mental health awareness among community college students and its influence on referral behavior. One of the most significant observations from this research is the strong relationship between students' awareness of mental health disorders (MHDs) and their willingness to guide peers toward appropriate and supportive resources.

Students who demonstrated higher awareness were considerably more likely to refer a friend showing signs of mental health problems to facilitative resources such as counseling centers, indicating that awareness plays a critical role in promoting positive help-seeking behavior.

Another important observation is that lack of awareness can lead to harmful outcomes. Students with lower awareness levels were less likely to recommend professional support and, in some cases, encouraged debilitative behaviors. This highlights how insufficient knowledge about mental health not only prevents timely intervention but may also worsen the condition of individuals experiencing psychological distress.

The study emphasizes that awareness does not merely influence attitudes but directly impacts actions taken by students when faced with mental health concerns among peers. The findings related to gender differences are also noteworthy. Male students were more likely than female students to refer friends to debilitative resources, suggesting that societal norms, misconceptions about mental health, and traditional gender roles may influence how students perceive and respond to mental health issues.

This observation underlines the need for gender-sensitive mental health awareness programs that address these biases and promote responsible peer support behaviors. the study draws attention to the limited focus of previous research on community college students compared to those attending four-year universities. By highlighting this gap, the research stresses the importance of inclusive mental health initiatives that consider diverse educational settings.

The observations from this research strongly support the need for structured awareness campaigns, counselling outreach, and peer education programs within college institutions. For the present study on mental health awareness among college students, these findings highlight the practical importance of awareness in shaping help-seeking behavior and strengthening student support systems.

CHAPTER 5

FINDINGS & SOCIAL IMPLICATIONS

QUESTIONS AND ITS INTERPRETATION FINDINGS

1.How confident do you feel in recognizing early signs of stress or mental health challenges in yourself?

OPTIONS	NO. OF STUDENTS	PERCENTAGE%
A. very confident	**20**	**40%**
B. somewhat confident	**25**	**50%**
C. not confident	**5**	**10%**
TOTAL STUDENTS AND PERCENTAGE	***50***	***100%***

Interpretation:

The above table indicates that a majority of students have a reasonable level of awareness regarding their mental health. Half of the respondents (50%) reported feeling somewhat confident in recognizing early signs of stress or mental health challenges in themselves, while a significant portion (40%) felt very confident.

This suggests that many students possess basic self-awareness and are able to identify changes in their mental well-being. However, 10% of the students reported not feeling confident, highlighting the need for increased mental health education and awareness programs to help all students better recognize and address early warning signs.

2. How comfortable are you discussing mental-health concerns with friends and faculty?

OPTIONS	NO. OF STUDENTS	PERCENTAGE
A. very comfortable	**18**	**36%**
B. somewhat comfortable	**13**	**26%**
C. not comfortable	**19**	**38%**
TOTAL STUDENTS AND PERCENTAGE	***50***	***100%***

<u>Interpretation</u>:

The above table shows the mixed levels of comfort among students when it comes to discussing mental health concerns with friends and faculty. While 36% of the students reported feeling very comfortable and 26% felt somewhat comfortable, a notable 38% indicated that they are not comfortable sharing their mental health concerns.

This suggests that although some students feel supported and open to communication, a significant number still hesitate to seek help due to fear, stigma, or lack of trust. The findings highlight the need to create a more supportive and open environment within colleges that encourages honest discussions about mental health.

3.What improvements do you think your college should implement to better support students' mental well-being?

OPTIONS	NO. OF STUDENTS	PERCENTAGE
A. more workshops and awareness programs	**14**	**28%**
B. Better access to counsellors	**-**	**-**
C. stress management sessions	**18**	**36%**
D. peer-support groups	**10**	**20%**
E. no improvement needed	**8**	**16%**
TOTAL STUDENTS AND PERCENTAGE	***50***	***100%***

Interpretation:

The above table suggest that students feel there is a clear need for enhanced mental health support within the college. The most preferred improvement was the introduction of *stress management sessions*, chosen by 36% of students, indicating that academic and personal stress is a major concern.

Additionally, 28% of respondents emphasized the need for *more workshops and awareness programs*, showing interest in gaining better knowledge about mental well-being. *Peer-support groups* were supported by 20% of students, highlighting the value of shared experiences and mutual support.

However, 16% of respondents felt that *no improvements were necessary*, suggesting satisfaction with existing facilities. Overall, the findings underline the importance of implementing diverse mental health initiatives to cater to the varying needs of students.

4.How would you rate the overall mental-health awareness among students in your community?

OPTIONS	NO. OF STUDENTS	PERCENTAGE
A. HIGH	**17**	**34%**
B. MODERATE	**28**	**56%**
C. LOW	**5**	**10%**
TOTAL STUDENTS & PERCENTAGE	***50***	***100%***

Interpretation:

The above table indicates that mental health awareness among students in the community is generally at a *moderate level*. A majority of respondents (56%) rated awareness as *moderate*, suggesting that while students possess some understanding of mental health issues, there is still room for improvement.

Meanwhile, 34% of students perceived awareness to be *high*, reflecting growing openness and knowledge in certain groups. However, 10% rated awareness as *low*, pointing to gaps in understanding and the continued presence of stigma.

5.What factors on campus contribute most to your stress levels?

OPTIONS	NO. OF STUDENTS	PERCENTAGE
A. Academic workload	**20**	**40%**
B. Exams and deadlines	**3**	**6%**
C. Financial pressure	**8**	**16%**
D. Social expectations	**5**	**10%**
E. Lack of time	**10**	**20%**
F. other	**4**	**8%**
TOTAL STUDENTS & PERCENTAGE	***50***	***100%***

Interpretation:

The above table indicates that *academic workload* is the primary source of stress among students, reported by 40% of the respondents, indicating the pressure of assignments, classes, and academic responsibilities. *Lack of time* was the next major factor, affecting 20% of students, suggesting difficulties in balancing academics with personal life. *Financial pressure* contributed to stress for 16% of students, reflecting concerns related to expenses and economic responsibilities.

Additionally, *social expectations* (10%) and *other factors* (8%) also played a role in influencing stress levels. Only a small proportion of students (6%) identified *exams and deadlines* as their main stressor. Overall, the results highlight that academic and time-management challenges are the dominant contributors to student stress, emphasizing the need for better academic planning and support systems on campus.

6. What stigma, if any, do you believe still exist around mental health among college students?

OPTIONS	NO. OF STUDENTS	PERCENTAGE
A. students fear being judged	**14**	**28%**
B. students think mental health is not serious	**16**	**32%**
C. students avoid seeking help	**8**	**16%**
D. no major stigma	**12**	**24%**
TOTAL STUDENTS AND PERCENTAGE	***50***	***100%***

Interpretation:

The above table indicates that stigma around mental health is still present among college students. The most commonly perceived issue, reported by 32% of students, is the belief that *mental health concerns are not taken seriously*. Additionally, 28% of respondents felt that *fear of being judged* prevents students from openly discussing mental health issues.

Another 16% noted that students tend to *avoid seeking help*, reflecting hesitation and internalized stigma. However, 24% of the students believed that there is *no major stigma*, suggesting gradual improvement in attitudes.

7.How often do you engage in activities that help you manage stress effectively?

OPTIONS	NO. OF STUDENTS	PERCENTAGE
A. regularly	**17**	**34%**
B. Occasionally	**23**	**46%**
C. Rarely	**10**	**20%**
TOTAL STUDENTS AND PERCENTAGE	***50***	***100%***

Interpretation:

The above table show that most students engage in stress-management activities, but not on a consistent basis. Nearly half of the respondents (46%) reported practicing such activities *occasionally*, indicating irregular stress-coping habits.

Meanwhile, 34% of students stated that they engage in stress-management activities *regularly*, reflecting a proactive approach toward maintaining their mental well-being.

However, 20% of the students reported *rarely* engaging in these activities, suggesting a lack of time, awareness, or motivation.

8. How familiar are you with common mental health issues (like Anxiety, depression, stress) among college students?

OPTION	NO. OF STUDENTS	PERCENTAGE
A. Very familiar	**20**	**40%**
B. Somewhat familiar	**20**	**40%**
C. Not familiar	**10**	**20%**
TOTAL STUDENTS AND PERCENTAGE	***50***	***100%***

Interpretation:

The above table indicate that most students have at least a basic understanding of common mental health issues such as anxiety, depression, and stress.

An equal proportion of respondents (40% each) reported being *very familiar* and *somewhat familiar* with these issues, suggesting a fair level of awareness among the student population.

However, 20% of students stated that they are *not familiar* with common mental health conditions, highlighting existing gaps in knowledge. Overall, the results emphasize the importance of continued mental health education to ensure that all students are well-informed and able to recognize mental health concerns.

9. Do you feel there is a stigma around seeking mental health support on campus?

OPTION	NO. OF STUDENTS	PERCENTAGE
A. Strongly agree	**8**	**16%**
B. Agree	**22**	**44%**
C. Neutral	**17**	**34%**
D. Disagree	**3**	**6%**
TOTAL STUDENTS AND PERCENTAGE	***50***	***100%***

Interpretation:

The above table results suggest that a significant number of students perceive a stigma around seeking mental health support on campus.

Nearly half of the respondents (44%) *agree* and 16% *strongly agree* that such stigma exists, indicating that social or cultural pressures may discourage students from accessing help.

Meanwhile, 34% of students were *neutral*, which could imply uncertainty or mixed experiences regarding stigma.

Only a small portion (6%) *disagreed*, suggesting that very few students feel there is no stigma. Overall, the findings highlight the need to foster a more supportive and stigma-free environment for mental health support on campus.

10. How confident are you in accessing mental health resources (counsellors, helplines, workshops) provided by your college?

OPTION	NO. OF STUDENTS	PERCENTAGE
A. Very confident	**18**	**36%**
B. Somewhat confident	**26**	**52%**
C. Not confident	**6**	**12%**
TOTAL STUDENTS AND PERCENTAGE	***50***	***100%***

Interpretation:

The above table results show that most students feel reasonably confident in accessing mental health resources provided by their college. Over half of the respondents (52%) reported being *somewhat confident*, while 36% stated they are *very confident* in utilizing services such as counsellors, helplines, and workshops.

However, 12% of students expressed that they are *not confident*, indicating that a small group may face barriers such as lack of awareness or hesitation in seeking help.

11. How often do you engage in activities that help maintain your mental well-being (like exercise, hobbies, meditation)?

OPTION	NO. OF STUDENTS	PERCENTAGE
A. Yes, definitely	**24**	**48%**
B. Maybe	**25**	**50%**
C. Not needed	**1**	**2%**
TOTAL STUDENTS AND PERCENTAGE	***50***	***100%***

Interpretation:

The above table results indicate that most students recognize the importance of engaging in activities that support their mental well-being. Half of the respondents (50%) responded with *maybe*, suggesting that while they participate in such activities, it may not be consistent or a regular habit.

Meanwhile, 48% of students answered *yes, definitely*, showing a strong commitment to practices like exercise, hobbies, or meditation. Only a small fraction (2%) felt that such activities are *not needed*, indicating minimal disregard for mental well-being.

12. Do you think your college should organize more programs or workshops to increase mental health awareness?

OPTION	NO. OF STUDENTS	PERCENTAGE
A. Yes, definitely	**29**	**58%**
B. Maybe	**11**	**22%**
C. Not needed	**9**	**18%**
TOTAL STUDENTS AND PERCENTAGE	***50***	***100%***

Interpretation:

The above table indicate a strong demand among students for increased mental health awareness initiatives in college. A majority of respondents (58%) answered *yes, definitely*, expressing a clear interest in more programs and workshops focused on mental well-being.

Additionally, 22% responded with *maybe*, showing some openness to participating in such initiatives. Only 18% of students felt that additional programs are *not needed*, suggesting that a small portion of students are satisfied with the current level of awareness activities.

Overall, the results highlight the importance of organizing more structured and accessible mental health programs to educate and support the student community effectively.

13. How much does the pressure to achieve high grades contribute to your mental health strain?

OPTION	NO. OF STUDENTS	PERCENTAGE
A. A lot	**9**	**18%**
B. A fair amount	**25**	**50%**
C. A little	**13**	**26%**
D. Not at all	**3**	**6%**
TOTAL STUDENTS AND PERCENTAGE	***50***	***100%***

Interpretation:

The above table results indicate that academic pressure plays a significant role in students' mental health strain. Half of the respondents (50%) reported that the pressure to achieve high grades affects them *a fair amount*, showing that it is a common source of stress.

Additionally, 18% of students felt it affects them *a lot*, highlighting a smaller group experiencing considerable pressure. Meanwhile, 26% reported that it affects them *a little*, and only 6% stated *not at all*, suggesting that for a few students, grades are not a major stressor.

14. How often do you use social media as a way to cope with or distract from stress?

OPTION	NO. OF STUDENTS	PERCENTAGE
A. Very often	**20**	**40%**
B. Occasionally	**26**	**52%**
C. Rarely	**-**	**-**
D. Never	**4**	**8%**
TOTAL STUDENTS AND PERCENTAGE	***50***	***100%***

Interpretation:

The above table results show that social media is a common coping mechanism for stress among students.

A majority of respondents (52%) reported using it *occasionally* to manage or distract from stress, while 40% admitted to using it *very often*, indicating that many students rely on digital platforms as a way to relax or escape stressful situations.

Only a small portion (8%) said they *never* use social media for this purpose, suggesting that few students avoid it altogether. Overall, the findings highlight the prominent role of social media in students' stress management, which may have both positive and negative implications for their mental well-being.

15. Have you noticed an increase in your stress or anxiety levels since starting college?

OPTION	NO. OF STUDENTS	PERCENTAGE
A. Yes, significantly	**19**	**38%**
B. Yes, somewhat	**18**	**36%**
C. No, they are about the same	**9**	**18%**
D. They've decreased	**4**	**8%**
TOTAL STUDENTS AND PERCENTAGE	***50***	***100%***

Interpretation:

The results indicate that a majority of students have experienced an increase in stress or anxiety since starting college.

A combined 74% of respondents reported a rise in stress levels, with 38% stating it has increased *significantly* and 36% noting it has increased *somewhat*.

Meanwhile, 18% of students felt that their stress levels have remained *about the same*, and only 8% reported that their stress or anxiety has *decreased*.

16. If you have sought mental health support on campus, how would you rate the experience?

OPTION	NO. OF STUDENTS	PERCENTAGE
A. Excellent	**11**	**22%**
B. Good	**26**	**52%**
C. Fair	**7**	**14%**
D. Poor	**5**	**10%**
E. Not applicable (have not sought support)	**1**	**2%**
TOTAL STUDENTS AND PERCENTAGE	***50***	***100%***

Interpretation:

The above table indicate that students who have sought mental health support on campus generally had positive experiences. More than half of the respondents (52%) rated their experience as *good*, while 22% described it as *excellent*, reflecting overall satisfaction with the available services.

Meanwhile, 14% rated their experience as *fair* and 10% as *poor*, suggesting that some students faced challenges or unmet expectations. Only 2% of students indicated *not applicable*, meaning they have not sought support.

Overall, the results highlight that while campus mental health resources are largely effective, there is still room for improvement to ensure all students receive high-quality support.

17. How much does your financial situation contribute to your overall stress?

OPTION	NO. OF STUDENTS	PERCENTAGE
A. Significantly	**13**	**26%**
B. Moderately	**21**	**42%**
C. Slightly	**10**	**20%**
D. Not at all	**6**	**12%**
TOTAL STUDENTS AND PERCENTAGE	***50***	***100%***

Interpretation:

The above table reveal that financial factors play a considerable role in shaping students' mental health and stress levels. The largest group, 42% of respondents, reported that financial concerns affect them *moderately*, indicating that while it may not be overwhelming, it consistently contributes to daily stress.

Additionally, 26% of students feel their financial situation impacts their stress *significantly*, highlighting a subset of students who may struggle with tuition fees, living expenses, or personal financial responsibilities. Another 20% reported that finances contribute only *slightly* to their stress, suggesting they have either stable financial support or effective coping strategies.

Only 12% indicated that their financial situation has *no impact*, showing that for a small number of students, financial pressures are not a concern. Overall, these results underscore the importance of offering financial counseling, scholarships, or budget management workshops to help students mitigate stress and maintain better mental well-being.

18. Have you ever considered dropping a course or taking a leave of absence due to mental health concerns?

OPTION	NO. OF STUDENTS	PERCENTAGE
A. Yes, I have	**4**	**8%**
B. No, but I've considered it	**21**	**42%**
C. No, never	**25**	**50%**
TOTAL STUDENTS AND PERCENTAGE	***50***	***100%***

Interpretation:

The above table results indicate that mental health concerns have influenced students' thoughts about continuing their academic workload to some extent. Half of the respondents (50%) stated that they have *never* considered dropping a course or taking a leave of absence, suggesting that their mental health has not yet reached a critical point affecting academics.

However, 42% reported that they have *considered it*, reflecting significant stress or challenges that make them contemplate taking a break. Only 8% have actually taken such steps due to mental health concerns.

19. How confident are you in helping a friend who is experiencing a mental health crisis?

OPTION	NO. OF STUDENTS	PERCENTAGE
A. Very confident	**16**	**32%**
B. Somewhat confident	**21**	**42%**
C. Not confident	**13**	**26%**
TOTAL STUDENTS AND PERCENTAGE	***50***	***100%***

Interpretation:

The above table show that students have varying levels of confidence in supporting friends experiencing a mental health crisis. A majority of respondents (42%) reported being *somewhat confident*, indicating that while they may have some knowledge or skills, they are not fully assured in their ability to help.

Meanwhile, 32% of students feel *very confident*, suggesting a good level of awareness and readiness to provide support. However, 26% admitted they are *not confident*, highlighting a need for training or guidance on how to respond effectively in mental health crises.

Overall, the results emphasize the importance of promoting peer-support training and awareness programs to equip students with the skills and confidence to assist friends in need.

20. How well do you manage the balance between your academic life and your personal life?

OPTION	NO. OF STUDENTS	PERCENTAGE
A. Very well	**21**	**42%**
B. Adequately	**22**	**44%**
C. poorly	**5**	**10%**
D. I don't maintain a balance	**2**	**4%**
TOTAL STUDENTS AND PERCENTAGE	***50***	***100%***

Interpretation:

The results indicate that most students are able to maintain a reasonable balance between their academic and personal lives. Nearly half of the respondents (44%) reported managing it *adequately*, while 42% stated they manage it *very well*, showing that a majority of students are able to cope with academic demands while attending to personal needs.

However, 10% admitted to managing it *poorly*, and 4% indicated that they *do not maintain a balance* at all, highlighting a small group struggling with time management and stress.

FINDINGS

The findings of this study indicate that mental health education plays a significant role in improving students' awareness, understanding, and attitudes toward mental health. Exposure to mental health education and training has helped students recognize mental health issues more clearly and has contributed to reducing stigma associated with mental illness. The study demonstrates that educational experiences have a direct and positive influence on students' perceptions, enabling them to view mental health as an important and legitimate aspect of well-being.

The results also show that students are generally aware of strategies that help maintain mental health, such as exercise, hobbies, and stress-management techniques. However, engagement in these activities tends to be irregular rather than consistent. This suggests a gap between awareness and practice, indicating the need to encourage students to adopt these strategies more intentionally and as part of their daily routine.

Mental health awareness among students appears to be at a moderate level, reflecting a basic understanding of common mental health issues. While awareness is increasing, gaps in knowledge remain, highlighting the importance of continued awareness programs to strengthen mental health literacy across the student community. Regular workshops and educational initiatives could help deepen understanding and normalize conversations around mental well-being.

Stigma related to mental health continues to be a significant concern. Many students still fear being judged or believe that mental health issues are not taken seriously, which discourages help-seeking behavior. This indicates that stigma, though reduced, has not been eliminated and must be addressed through sustained education, peer support, and a more open campus culture.

In conclusion, the findings highlight that while progress has been made in mental health awareness among college students, consistent engagement, stigma reduction, and stronger institutional support remain essential. Strengthening mental health education, promoting regular well-being practices, and creating a supportive campus environment can significantly enhance students' mental health and academic experience.

SUGGESTIONS

Based on the findings of the study, several measures can be suggested to enhance mental health awareness and support among college students. Strengthening mental health education should be a priority, as it has shown a positive impact on students' understanding and attitudes. Integrating mental health topics into the academic curriculum through seminars, orientation programs, and classroom discussions can help normalize conversations around mental well-being and reduce stigma.

Colleges should organize regular workshops and awareness programs that focus not only on identifying mental health issues but also on practical coping strategies. Sessions on stress management, mindfulness, time management, and emotional resilience can encourage students to adopt healthier routines and engage more consistently in activities that support mental well-being.

Efforts should be made to create a stigma-free campus environment. Awareness campaigns, student-led initiatives, and open discussions can help challenge misconceptions related to mental health. Encouraging faculty members to openly address mental health concerns and provide supportive responses can further promote a culture of acceptance and trust.

Improving accessibility to mental health resources is essential. Colleges should ensure that counseling services are easily approachable, well-publicized, and confidential. Clear information about available services, appointment procedures, and helplines should be communicated through multiple platforms such as notice boards, emails, and student portals to increase students' confidence in seeking help.

CHAPTER 6

CONCLUSION

The survey on mental health awareness among college students reveals several important insights into the current state of student well-being, coping mechanisms, and perceptions surrounding mental health on campus. Overall, the majority of students demonstrate a moderate to high level of self-awareness regarding their own mental health. Many students feel somewhat to very confident in recognizing early signs of stress and accessing available mental health resources, indicating growing awareness and comfort with seeking support. However, a notable portion still lacks confidence, underscoring the need for continued education and accessible guidance.

When it comes to discussing mental health concerns, the survey highlights mixed levels of comfort. While some students feel open to sharing their struggles with friends or faculty, a significant number remain hesitant, reflecting ongoing stigma and fear of judgment. This is further supported by findings that students perceive persistent stigma on campus, such as beliefs that mental health is not taken seriously or that seeking help may lead to being judged.

Academic pressures, particularly workload and the drive to achieve high grades, emerged as the primary sources of stress, followed by time constraints, financial concerns, and social expectations. Most students reported an increase in stress or anxiety since starting college, and many occasionally or very often use coping mechanisms such as social media, hobbies, or stress-management activities. Although a good proportion engage regularly in mental well-being practices, some students still lack consistent coping strategies.

Students expressed a clear interest in enhanced mental health support, including more workshops, awareness programs, stress management sessions, and peer-support initiatives. Positive feedback was reported from those who have used campus mental health resources, though a small fraction experienced less satisfactory support, indicating room for improvement in service delivery.

The findings also highlight the social dimension of mental health: while students show moderate confidence in helping friends during crises, a substantial portion still feel unprepared, suggesting the value of peer-support training. Balancing academic and personal life remains manageable for most, yet a minority struggles significantly, reinforcing the importance of promoting time-management skills and stress-reduction programs.

CHAPTER 7

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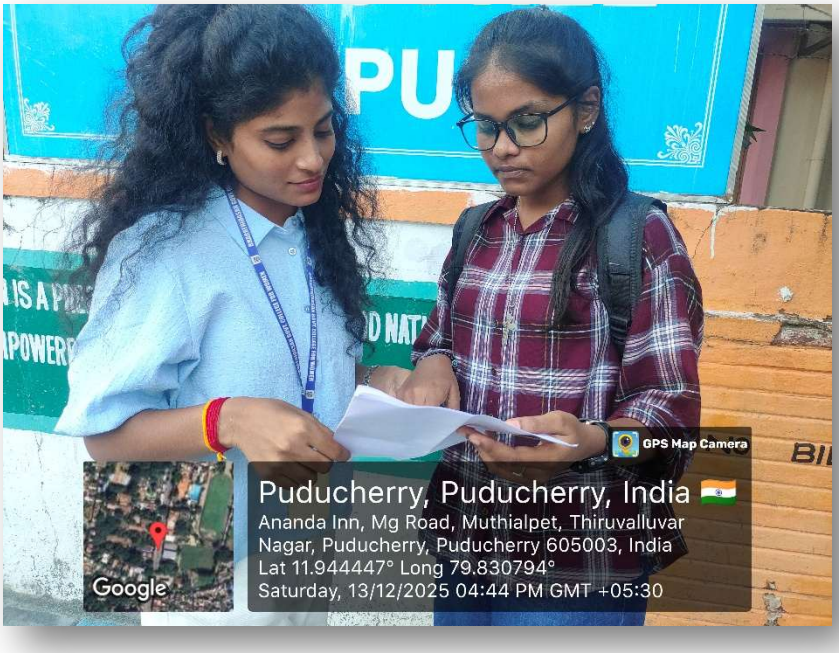
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CHAPTER-8 ANNEXURE

PHOTO GALLERY

TEAM MEMBER: A.SRI DEVI / COLLEGE NAME: BHARATHIDASAN GOVT COLLEGE FOR WOMEN.



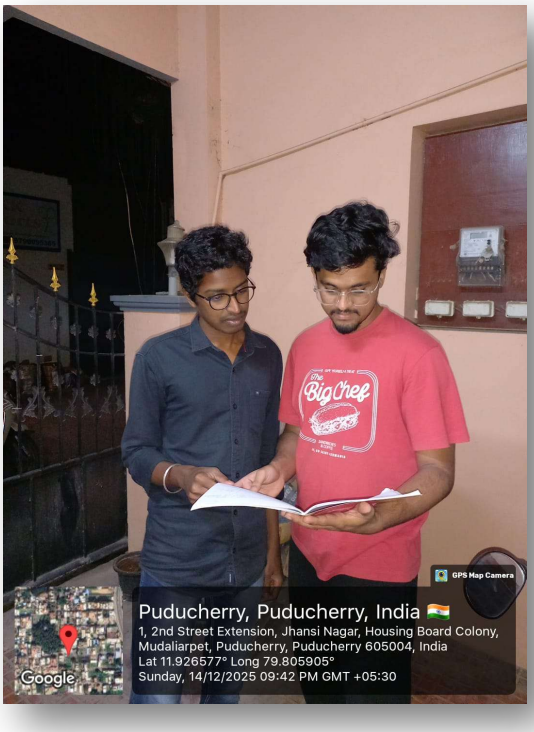


TEAM MEMBER: Z. RAAFIYA TABASSUM / COLLEGE NAME: RAAK COLLEGE OF ENGENEERING AND TECHNOLOGY.





TEAM MEMBER: V.PUTHIN / COLLEGE NAME: SARADHA GANGHADHARAN COLLEGE.





TEAM MEMBER: S. VIJAYAVARATHAN / SMVEC MADAGADIPET.





QUESTIONNAIRE

1.How confident do you feel in recognizing early signs of stress or mental health challenges in yourself?

Options: *Very confident / Somewhat confident / Not confident*

2. How comfortable are you discussing mental-health concerns with friends and faculty?

Options: *Very comfortable / Somewhat comfortable / Not comfortable*

3. What improvements do you think your college should implement to better support students' mental well-being?

Options: *More workshops and awareness programs / Better access to counselors / Stress-Management sessions / Peer-support groups / No improvement needed*

4. How would you rate the overall mental-health awareness among students in your campus community?

Options: *High / Moderate / Low*

5. What factors on campus contribute most to your stress levels?

Options: *Academic workload / Exams and deadlines / Financial pressure / Social expectations / Lack of time / Other*

6. What stigma, if any, do you believe still exist around mental health among college students?

Options: *Students fear being judged / Students think mental health is not serious / Students avoid seeking help / No major stigma*

7. How often do you engage in activities that help you manage stress effectively?

Options*: Regularly / Occasionally / Rarely*

8. How familiar are you with common mental health issues (like Anxiety, depression, stress) among college students?

Options: *Very familiar / somewhat familiar / not familiar*

9. Do you feel there is a stigma around seeking mental health support on campus?

Options: *strongly agree / agree / Neutral / disagree*

10. How confident are you in accessing mental health resources (counselors, helplines, workshops) provided by your college?

Options: *very confident / somewhat confident / not confident*

11. How often do you engage in activities that help maintain your mental well-being (like exercise, hobbies, meditation)?

Options: *yes, definitely / Maybe / not needed*

12. Do you think your college should organize more programs or workshops to increase mental health awareness?

Options: *yes definitely / Maybe / not needed*

13. How much does the pressure to achieve high grades contribute to your mental health strain?

Options: *A lot / A fair amount / A little / Not at all*

14. How often do you use social media as a way to cope with or distract from stress?

Options: *Very often / Occasionally / Rarely / Never*

15. Have you noticed an increase in your stress or anxiety levels since starting college?

Options: *Yes, significantly / Yes, somewhat / No, they are about the same / No, they have decreased*

16. If you have sought mental health support on campus, how would you rate the experience?

Options: *Excellent / Good / Fair / Poor / Not applicable (have not sought support)*

17. How much does your financial situation contribute to your overall stress?

Options: *Significantly / Moderately / Slightly / Not at all*

18. Have you ever considered dropping a course or taking a leave of absence due to mental health concerns?

Options*: Yes, I have / No, but I've considered it / No, never*

19. How confident are you in helping a friend who is experiencing a mental health crisis?

Options: *Very confident / Somewhat confident / Not confident*

20. How well do you manage the balance between your academic life and your personal life?

Options: *Very well / Adequately / Poorly / I don't maintain a balance*

THANK YOU